

Word family: **leave / leaves / left / leaving / leftover / leave-taking**

Base word: leave

Past tense / past participle: left

ing form: leaving

Related forms / useful extensions:

* **leave** (v.) — 離開；留下；交給；使處於某狀態

* **leave** (n.) — 假期；准假

* **leftover** (n./adj.) — 剩餘物；剩下的

* **leave-taking** (n.) — 告別；離別 (較正式 / 文學)

Useful patterns:

* **leave a place**

* **leave for somewhere**

* **leave someone alone**

* **leave something somewhere**

* **leave something behind**

* **leave something open/on**

* **leave someone doing something**

* **leave someone with something**

* **leave something to someone**

* **leave someone something**

* **leave a message**

* **leave school / work**

* **leave a job**

* **leave someone**

* **leave it to someone**

* **be left**

* **have something left**

* **take leave**

* **annual leave / sick leave / maternity leave**

Meaning in this passage

> Whenever I spend time with him, I always **leave** in a better mood.

Here, **leave** means:

to go away from a place or person — 離開；離去

The speaker means that after spending time with Leo, they go away feeling happier.

****中文翻譯：****

每次和他相處之後，我離開時心情總會****變得更好****。

So here:

**leave = 離開某個地方 / 某人身邊**

1. **leave a place — 離開某地**

This is the core meaning and the one used in your passage.

Practice 1 — original sentence

> Whenever I spend time with him, I always ****leave**** in a better mood.

每次和他相處後，我離開時心情總會****更好****。

Practice 2

> We ****left the restaurant**** at ten.

我們十點****離開餐廳****。

Practice 3

> She ****left home**** early this morning.

她今天一早便****離開家****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****leave = 從某個地方離去，不再留在那裏****

2. **leave for somewhere — 出發前往某地**

Practice 1

> We ****leave for Tokyo**** tomorrow morning.

我們明早****出發前往東京****。

Practice 2

> She **left for work** at seven.

她七點**出門上班**。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****leave for somewhere = 離開目前所在地並出發前往另一個地方****

3. ****leave someone — 離開某人；與某人分開****

Practice 1

> He **left his family** and moved abroad.

他**離開家人**，搬到外國。

Practice 2

> She didn't want to **leave him alone**.

她不想**把他一個人留下**。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****leave someone = 離開某人所在之處，或不再陪伴對方****

4. ****leave someone alone — 不打擾某人；讓某人獨處****

A very common expression.

Practice 1

> Please **leave me alone** for a while.

請**讓我一個人靜一靜**。

Practice 2

> The child wanted to **leave the dog alone**.

那個孩子想**不要再打擾那隻狗**。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****leave someone alone = 不再打擾、干預或陪伴某人，讓對方獨處****

5. ****leave something somewhere — 把某物留在某處****

Practice 1

> I ****left my phone at home****.

我把手機****留在家裏了****。

Practice 2

> She ****left the keys on the table****.

她把鎖匙****留在桌上****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****leave something somewhere = 離開時沒有把某物帶走，令它留在某個地方****

6. ****leave something behind — 留下；忘記帶走****

Practice 1

> I accidentally ****left my bag behind****.

我不小心****把袋子留下了****。

Practice 2

> Don't ****leave anything behind****.

不要****留下任何東西****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****leave something behind = 離開某處時沒有把某物帶走****

7. ****leave something open/on/unlocked — 讓某物保持某狀態****

This is a major grammar pattern.

Practice 1

> She **left the window open**.

她讓窗戶**開着**。

Practice 2

> Don't **leave the lights on**.

不要讓燈一直**開着**。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****leave + object + adjective/particle = 使某物保持在某個狀態****

8. ****leave someone waiting / standing / wondering — 讓某人一直處於某狀態****

Practice 1

> They **left us waiting** for an hour.

他們讓我們**等了一個小時**。

Practice 2

> His answer **left me wondering** what he really meant.

他的回答令我一直**在想他真正的意思**。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****leave someone doing something = 使某人繼續處於某種行動或狀態****

9. ****leave someone/something + adjective — 令……變成某狀態****

Practice 1

> The news **left her speechless**.

那個消息令她**說不出話來**。

Practice 2

> The long walk **left us exhausted**.

那段長途步行令我們**筋疲力盡**。

MCQ-ready definition:

leave someone/something + adjective = 令某人或某物最後處於某種狀態

10. **leave someone with something — 留給某人某種感受 / 結果**

Practice 1

> The film **left me with a strange feeling**.

那部電影**留給我一種奇怪的感覺**。

Practice 2

> The experience **left him with lasting memories**.

那次經歷**留給他長久的回憶**。

MCQ-ready definition:

leave someone with something = 某件事結束後令某人仍保留某種感受、結果或事物

11. **leave something to someone — 把某事交給某人處理**

Practice 1

> **Leave it to me**.

交給我吧。

Practice 2

> We **left the decision to her**.

我們把決定**交給她來做**。

MCQ-ready definition:

leave something to someone = 把某項責任、決定或工作交由某人處理

12. **leave someone something — 留給某人某物；遺留**

Practice 1

> She **left me a note**.

她**留了一張字條給我**。

Practice 2

> His grandfather **left him a small house**.

他的祖父**留了一間小屋給他**。

MCQ-ready definition:

leave someone something = 留下某物讓某人收到；也可指遺產

13. **leave something to someone in a will — 遺贈；在遺囑中留給**

Practice 1

> She **left the house to her daughter**.

她把房子**留給女兒作遺產**。

Practice 2

> He **left most of his money to charity**.

他把大部分財產**遺贈給慈善機構**。

MCQ-ready definition:

leave something to someone = 在去世後把財產透過遺囑留給某人或機構

14. **leave a message — 留言**

Practice 1

> Can I **leave a message**?

我可以**留言**嗎？

Practice 2

> She **left me a voicemail message**.

她給我**留了一段語音訊息**。

MCQ-ready definition:

leave a message = 在對方未能即時接收時，把訊息留下讓其稍後取得

15. **leave school / university — 離校；畢業 / 退學**

Practice 1

> He **left school** at eighteen.

他十八歲時**離開學校**。

Practice 2

> She **left university** and started working.

她**離開大學**後開始工作。

MCQ-ready definition:

leave school/university = 結束在該教育機構的就讀狀態

16. **leave a job / company — 離職；離開公司**

Practice 1

> She **left her job** last month.

她上個月**辭職了**。

Practice 2

> He is planning to **leave the company**.

他正計劃**離開公司 / 辭職**。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****leave a job/company = 停止在某職位或公司工作****

17. ****leave someone (伴侶) — 離開伴侶；分手****

Practice 1

> She decided to ****leave her husband****.

她決定****離開丈夫****。

Practice 2

> He was shocked when his partner ****left him****.

伴侶****離開他 / 與他分手****時，他非常震驚。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****leave someone = 結束伴侶關係並離開對方****

18. ****be left — 剩下；留下****

Practice 1

> Only two slices of cake are ****left****.

蛋糕只****剩下****兩片。

Practice 2

> There isn't much time ****left****.

****剩下的時間****不多了。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****be left = 在其他部分被使用、拿走或消失後仍然剩餘****

19. ****have something left — 還剩有某物****

Practice 1

> We have ten minutes **left**.

我們還**剩下十分鐘**。

Practice 2

> Do we have any milk **left**?

我們還有牛奶**剩下嗎**？

MCQ-ready definition:

have something left = 某物仍有一部分尚未用完、消失或離去

20. **leave over / leftover** — 剩餘；剩下的

The adjective/noun **leftover** is especially useful.

Practice 1

> We ate the **leftover food** the next day.

第二天我們吃了**剩下的食物**。

Practice 2

> There are some **leftovers** in the fridge.

雪櫃裏有一些**剩菜 / 剩下的食物**。

MCQ-ready definition:

leftover = 使用、進食或分配後仍然剩下的

21. **leave something out** — 漏掉；省略；不包括

A highly common phrasal extension.

Practice 1

> You **left out** an important detail.

你**漏掉了**一個重要細節。

Practice 2

> We can **leave this section out**.

我們可以**省略這一部分**。

MCQ-ready definition:

leave something out = 不包括、沒有提及或遺漏某人 / 某事

22. **feel left out — 感到被冷落 / 被排除**

Practice 1

> He felt **left out** when everyone else was invited.

其他人都獲邀時，他感到自己**被冷落了**。

Practice 2

> Make sure nobody feels **left out**.

要確保沒有人感到**被排除在外**。

MCQ-ready definition:

feel left out = 覺得自己沒有被包括在某個群體、活動或社交互動中

23. **leave off — 停止；中斷**

Less common than **stop**, but useful.

Practice 1

> Let's continue where we **left off**.

我們從上次**停下來的地方**繼續吧。

Practice 2

> Where did we **leave off** yesterday?

我們昨天講到哪裏**停下來**了？

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****leave off = 停止某項活動；常見於 `where we left off` = 上次停止的位置****

24. ****leave alone / leave well alone — 不干預；別碰****

Practice 1

> Just ****leave it alone****.

就****別管它 / 別碰它****。

Practice 2

> Sometimes it's better to ****leave well alone****.

有時候最好****不要多事去改動本來沒問題的東西****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****leave something alone = 不再碰、干預或處理某事****

25. ****leave it at that — 就此打住；不再追究****

Practice 1

> We agreed to disagree and ****left it at that****.

我們同意彼此意見不同，然後****就此打住****。

Practice 2

> I apologized, and she decided to ****leave it at that****.

我道了歉，她決定****不再追究****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****leave it at that = 不再繼續討論、爭辯或處理某件事****

26. ****leave something until later — 留待之後處理****

Practice 1

> Let's **leave this until tomorrow**.

我們把這件事**留到明天再處理**。

Practice 2

> Don't **leave everything until the last minute**.

不要把所有事情都**拖到最後一刻才做**。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****leave something until X = 暫時不處理，等到較後時間才做****

27. **leave room / space for something — 留出空間 / 餘地**

Practice 1

> **Leave some room** for dessert.

****留一點肚子**吃甜品。**

Practice 2

> The plan **leaves room for change**.

這個計劃**保留了改變的空間 / 彈性**。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****leave room for something = 保留足夠空間、機會或彈性讓某事發生****

28. **leave a mark / impression — 留下痕跡 / 印象**

Practice 1

> The experience **left a deep impression on me**.

那次經歷**給我留下深刻印象**。

Practice 2

> The accident **left a mark** on the wall.

意外在牆上**留下了痕跡**。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****leave a mark/impression = 令某種實際痕跡或長久印象仍然存在****

29. **leave someone in peace — 讓某人清靜**

Practice 1

> Please **leave me in peace**.

請**讓我清靜一下**。

Practice 2

> He just wanted to be **left in peace**.

他只想**不受打擾地待着**。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****leave someone in peace = 不打擾某人，讓其安靜獨處****

30. **leave (noun) — 假期；准假**

A genuinely distinct noun sense.

Practice 1

> She is on **annual leave** this week.

她這星期正在放**年假**。

Practice 2

> He requested three days' **leave**.

他申請了三天**假期**。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****leave = 獲正式批准暫時離開工作或職務的時間****

31. **annual leave — 年假**

Practice 1

> Employees receive twenty days of **annual leave**.

僱員每年有二十天**年假**。

Practice 2

> I'm taking **annual leave** next week.

我下星期會放**年假**。

MCQ-ready definition:

annual leave = 僱員每年按工作安排獲得的有薪或正式假期

32. **sick leave — 病假**

Practice 1

> She is currently on **sick leave**.

她目前正在放**病假**。

Practice 2

> He took two days of **sick leave**.

他請了兩天**病假**。

MCQ-ready definition:

sick leave = 因生病或健康原因獲准不工作的假期

33. **maternity / parental leave — 產假 / 育嬰假**

Practice 1

> She is on **maternity leave**.

她正在放**產假**。

Practice 2

> The company offers paid **parental leave**.

公司提供有薪**育嬰假 / 育兒假**。

MCQ-ready definition:

maternity/parental leave = 因生育或照顧新生子女而獲得的正式假期

34. **take leave of someone — 向某人告別**

Formal/literary.

Practice 1

> He **took leave of his friends** and departed.

他向朋友們**告別**後便離開了。

Practice 2

> She **took her leave** quietly.

她靜靜地**告辭了**。

MCQ-ready definition:

take leave of someone / take your leave = 正式或較文雅地向某人告別並離去

Important distinction 1: **leave vs go**

go

focuses on movement away/toward another place.

leave

focuses on departing from the current place/person.

> I **left the office** at six.

我六點離開辦公室。

> I **went home** at six.

我六點回家。

So:

* **leave + place you depart from**

* **go + destination**

Important distinction 2: **leave vs leave for**

leave London

= 離開倫敦

leave for London

= 出發前往倫敦

The preposition completely changes the direction.

Important distinction 3: **leave vs forget**

This is a classic learner trap.

leave something somewhere

you fail to take it with you.

> I **left my phone at home**.

我把手機留在家裏。

forget something

you fail to remember it.

> I **forgot my phone**.

我忘了帶手機 / 忘記手機這件事。

In many contexts both may lead to the same practical result, but the semantic focus differs.

Important distinction 4: **leave vs abandon**

leave

neutral and very broad.

abandon

much stronger:

= leave completely, often with no intention of returning or caring for something.

> She **left the house**.

她離開了房子。

> They **abandoned the house**.

他們棄置了房子。

Important distinction 5: **leave vs quit**

leave a job

neutral: stop working there.

quit a job

more directly emphasizes resigning voluntarily.

> She **left the company**.

她離開了公司。

> She **quit her job**.

她辭職了。

Important distinction 6: **leave someone vs break up with someone**

leave someone

can mean physically depart OR end a relationship.

break up with someone

specifically means end a romantic relationship.

Context determines **leave**.

Important distinction 7: **leave something open vs open something**

open the window

perform the action.

leave the window open

make sure it **remains** open.

So **leave + adjective** focuses on the resulting state.

Important distinction 8: **leave someone waiting vs make someone wait**

Very close:

> They **left me waiting** for an hour.

> They **made me wait** for an hour.

But **left me waiting** often emphasizes that the waiting continued while they did not attend to me.

Important distinction 9: **left = past of leave vs left = opposite of right**

These are homographs/homophones in modern English.

Verb

> She ****left**** early.

她提早離開。

Direction

> Turn ****left****.

向左轉。

These are separate lexical items despite identical spelling/pronunciation.

Important distinction 10: ****left = remaining****

Another highly important use:

> There are two cakes ****left****.

還剩兩件蛋糕。

This develops from:

****others leave/go away → something remains behind****

So it is related to ****leave****, but learners need to recognize the fixed ****remaining**** sense quickly.

Important distinction 11: ****leave someone something vs leave something to someone****

Both can mean give by inheritance or leave for someone.

> She ****left me the house****.

> She ****left the house to me****.

Both can mean:

她把房子遺留給我。

The grammar differs, but the core meaning is the same.

Important distinction 12: **leave out vs leave behind**

leave out

exclude/omit.

> You **left out** my name.

你漏了我的名字。

leave behind

depart without taking someone/something.

> You **left your bag behind**.

你把袋子留下了。

Important distinction 13: **leave alone vs leave behind**

leave alone

don't disturb/interfere.

leave behind

go away without taking.

> **Leave him alone.**

別打擾他。

> We **left him behind**.

我們把他留在後面 / 沒有帶他走。

Very different.

Important distinction 14: **leave = departure vs leave = holiday**

Verb

> I **leave** tomorrow.

我明天離開。

Noun

> I'm on **leave** tomorrow.

我明天放假。

This is genuine noun–verb polysemy and a common learner trap.

Family-extension note

Leave is one of the strongest polysemy verbs because several major concepts have developed around the core idea:

move away while something or someone remains

From that, English gets:

1. **depart**

- * leave home
- * leave work

2. **cause something to remain**

- * leave your phone at home
- * leave the door open

3. **produce a resulting state**

- * leave someone tired
- * leave someone wondering

4. **entrust / assign**

- * leave it to me

5. **give / bequeath**

- * leave someone a message

* leave property to someone

6. **remain**

* two minutes left

* leftovers

7. **noun: authorized absence**

* annual leave

* sick leave

These are genuine and highly productive branches, so **leave** is absolutely worth full polysemy treatment.

Master comparison

Form / expression	Traditional Chinese	Core idea
-----	-----	-----
leave a place	離開某地	depart
leave for X	出發前往 X	depart toward destination
leave someone	離開某人	depart from person
leave someone alone	不打擾某人	let remain undisturbed
leave X somewhere	把 X 留在某處	not take away
leave X behind	留下 / 忘記帶走 X	depart without X
leave the door open	讓門開着	maintain state
leave someone waiting	讓某人一直等	continue state/action
leave someone tired	令某人疲累	cause resulting state
leave someone with X	留給某人 X	lasting result
leave X to someone	把 X 交給某人	entrust
leave someone X	留給某人 X	give/bequeath
leave a message	留言	leave information
leave school	離校	end attendance
leave a job	離職	end employment
leave partner	離開伴侶 / 分手	end relationship
be left	剩下	remain
have X left	還剩 X	remaining amount
leftovers	剩餘食物 / 剩菜	remaining items
leave out	漏掉 ; 省略	omit
feel left out	感到被冷落	excluded
leave off	停止 ; 中斷	cease
leave it at that	就此打住	stop discussion
leave until later	留待之後處理	postpone
leave room for X	為 X 留餘地	retain space/flexibility

leave an impression	留下印象	lasting effect	
leave (noun)	假期；准假	authorized absence	
annual leave	年假	yearly work leave	
sick leave	病假	health-related leave	
parental leave	育嬰假	family leave	
take your leave	告辭	formal departure	

For your original sentence

> Overall, I like him a lot because he is curious, kind, and full of life, and whenever I spend time with him, I always **leave in a better mood**.

Here:

leave = 離開；離去

The important pattern is:

> **leave + in a better mood**

This means:

when I go away after spending time with him, my mood is better than before

A natural Traditional Chinese rendering is:

> 每次和他相處之後，我離開時心情總會**比之前更好**。

So the exact passage sense is the straightforward **depart/go away** meaning of **leave**, while the phrase **in a better mood** describes the speaker's emotional state at the time of departure.